

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent

12412013

Kind Code

B2

Date of Patent

September 09, 2025

Inventor(s)

Lee; Jonghyun et al.

Method of predicting characteristic of semiconductor device and computing device performing the same

Abstract

To predict characteristics of a semiconductor device, a simulation current-voltage curve of the semiconductor device is generated using compact models where each compact model generates simulation result data by performing a simulation based on device data. The simulation result data indicate characteristics of semiconductor devices corresponding to the device data. The compact models respectively corresponding to process data and semiconductor products. Simulation reference points on the simulation current-voltage curve are extracted. Basic training data corresponding to a combination of the simulation reference points and the simulation current-voltage curve are generated. A deep learning model is trained based on the basic training data such that the deep learning model outputs a prediction current-voltage curve. A target prediction current-voltage curve is generated based on the deep learning model and target reference points corresponding to the target semiconductor product. The deep learning model is a generative adversarial network.

Inventors: Lee; Jonghyun (Hwaseong-si, KR), Gil; Gwangnae (Yongin-si, KR), Park; Seyoung (Hwaseong-si, KR), Woo; Sola (Gwacheon-si, KR)

Applicant: Samsung Electronics Co., Ltd. (Suwon-si, KR)

Family ID: 86057442

Assignee: Samsung Electronics Co., Ltd. (Gyeonggi-do, KR)

Appl. No.: 17/741860

Filed: May 11, 2022

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier

US 20230125401 A1

Publication Date

Apr. 27, 2023

Foreign Application Priority Data

KR

10-2021-0141710

Oct. 22, 2021

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G06F30/3308 (20200101); G06F18/214 (20230101); G06F30/333 (20200101); G06N3/04 (20230101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC G06F30/3308 (20200101); G06F18/214 (20230101); G06F30/333 (20200101); G06N3/04 (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

USPC: 716/136

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
11053789	12/2020	Maher et al.	N/A	N/A
2020/0320366	12/2019	Wang et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0033680	12/2020	Ukumori	N/A	N/A
2021/0117841	12/2020	Rhodes	N/A	N/A
2023/0125401	12/2022	Lee	716/136	G06F 30/27

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
6620902	12/2018	JP	N/A
2020-0154604	12/2019	JP	N/A
10-2020-0119192	12/2019	KR	N/A
20230013995	12/2020	KR	G05B 19/41885

Primary Examiner: Alam; Mohammed

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Harness, Dickey & Pierce, P.L.C.

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

(1) This U.S. non-provisional application claims priority under 35 USC § 119 to Korean Patent Application No. 10-2021-0141710, filed on Oct. 22, 2021, in the Korean Intellectual Property Office (KIPO), the disclosure of which is incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

1. Technical Field

(2) Example embodiments relate generally to semiconductor integrated circuits, and more particularly to a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device based on deep learning and a computing device performing the method.

2. Discussion of the Related Art

(3) With development of the electronics industry, the design technology co-optimization (DTCO), in which the design of a semiconductor product is checked based on available manufacturing processes, is increasingly important. For example, in the foundry industry, a manufacturer may provide a device model corresponding to a target process level and a designer may design and simulate the semiconductor product using the device model. However, a change of the target process level may lead to a change of the device model. In this case, the designer has to change the established design, which may take an impractical and/or an enormous amount of time to newly perform a simulation based on the changed design, and accordingly, extra cost may be incurred to the manufacture and/or time loss may be incurred to the designer. Moreover, if the accuracy of a model performing the simulation is low, the performance of designed and manufactured product may be degraded due to inaccurate prediction of the characteristics of the semiconductor device.

SUMMARY

(4) Some example embodiments may provide a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device based on deep learning and a computing device performing the method, capable of efficiently predicting characteristics of semiconductor devices.

(5) According to some example embodiments, a method of predicting characteristics of a target semiconductor device included in a target semiconductor product, the method being performed by at least one processor executing program codes, the program codes stored in computer readable media, includes generating a simulation current-voltage curve using a plurality of compact models, the plurality of compact models respectively corresponding to a plurality of process data and a plurality of semiconductor products, and each of the plurality of compact models is configured to perform a simulation based on device data such that simulation result data, indicating characteristics of semiconductor devices corresponding to the device data, is generated; extracting a plurality of simulation reference points on the simulation current-voltage curve; generating basic training data corresponding to a combination of the plurality of simulation reference points and the simulation current-voltage curve; training a deep learning model based on the basic training data such that the deep learning model is configured to output a prediction current-voltage curve; and generating a target prediction current-voltage curve based on the deep learning model and a plurality of target reference points corresponding to the target semiconductor product. The deep learning model may be a generative adversarial network.

(6) According to some example embodiments, a method of predicting characteristics of a semiconductor device included in a target semiconductor product, the method being performed by at least one processor executing program codes, the program codes stored in computer readable media, includes generating a simulation current-voltage curve of the semiconductor device using a plurality of compact models, the plurality of compact models respectively corresponding to a plurality of process data and a plurality of semiconductor products, each of the plurality of compact models configured to perform a simulation based on device data such that simulation result data, indicating characteristics of semiconductor devices corresponding to the device data, is generated; extracting a plurality of simulation reference points on the simulation current-voltage curve; generating basic training data corresponding to a combination of the plurality of simulation reference points and the simulation current-voltage curve; training a deep learning model based on the basic training data such that the deep learning model is configured to output a prediction current-voltage curve and uncertainty data indicating uncertainty of the prediction current-voltage curve; generating a target prediction current-voltage curve based on the deep learning model and a plurality of target reference points corresponding to the target semiconductor product; and retraining the deep learning model based on the uncertainty data. The deep learning model may be

a generative adversarial network.

(7) According to example embodiments, a computing device includes a computer readable medium storing program codes and a plurality of compact models a computer readable medium storing program codes and a plurality of compact models, the plurality of compact models respectively corresponding to a plurality of process data and a plurality of semiconductor products, each of the plurality of compact models configured to perform a simulation based on device data such that simulation result data, indicating characteristics of semiconductor devices corresponding to the device data, is generated; and at least one processor configured to, when the program codes are executed, generate a simulation current-voltage curve of the semiconductor device using the plurality of compact models, extract a plurality of simulation reference points on the simulation current-voltage curve, generate basic training data corresponding to a combination of the plurality of simulation reference points and the simulation current-voltage curve, train the deep learning model based on the basic training data such that the deep learning model is configured to output a prediction current-voltage curve and generate a target prediction current-voltage curve based on the deep learning model and a plurality of target reference points corresponding to the target semiconductor product. The deep learning model may be a generative adversarial network.

(8) The method and the computing device according to some example embodiments may efficiently predict the characteristics of the semiconductor device included in the new semiconductor product, by generating the basic training data corresponding to the combinations of the simulation reference points and the simulation current-voltage curve using the established compact models corresponding to the previous semiconductor products and training the deep learning model based on the basic training data.

(9) In addition, the method and the computing device according to some example embodiments may provide the deep learning model configured to precisely predict the characteristics of the semiconductor device by training the deep learning model to output the prediction current-voltage curve indicating the characteristics of the semiconductor device and the uncertainty data indicating the uncertainty of the prediction current-voltage curve and retraining the deep learning model based on the uncertainty data.

(10) Through the enhanced prediction performance of the deep learning model, the time and/or the cost of designing and/or manufacturing the semiconductor product including the semiconductor device and the performance of the semiconductor product may be enhanced.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Example embodiments of the present disclosure will be more clearly understood from the following detailed description taken in conjunction with the accompanying drawings.

(2) FIG. 1 is a flowchart illustrating a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(3) FIG. 2 is a block diagram illustrating a computing device according to some example embodiments.

(4) FIG. 3 is a block diagram electronic device according to some example embodiments.

(5) FIG. 4A is a diagram illustrating an example of a simulation current-voltage curve and a plurality of simulation reference points in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(6) FIG. 4B is a diagram for describing training of a deep learning model in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(7) FIG. 4C is a diagram illustrating an example of a target current-voltage curve and a plurality of target reference points in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according

to some example embodiments.

(8) FIG. 5 is a diagram illustrating an example embodiment of a deep learning model in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(9) FIGS. 6A and 6B are diagrams for describing examples of a deep learning neural network structure that is driven by a machine learning device according to some example embodiments.

(10) FIG. 6C is a diagram illustrating an example of a node included in a neural network.

(11) FIGS. 7 and 8 are diagrams for describing relationship between a plurality of semiconductor products and a target semiconductor product in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(12) FIG. 9 is a diagram illustrating an example of a deep learning model in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(13) FIG. 10 is a diagram illustrating data in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(14) FIG. 11 is a flowchart illustrating a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(15) FIG. 12 is a diagram for describing types of uncertainty in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(16) FIG. 13 is a diagram illustrating an example of a deep learning model in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(17) FIG. 14 is a flow chart illustrating an example of retraining based on model uncertainty value in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(18) FIG. 15 is a diagram illustrating an addition data range in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(19) FIG. 16 is a flow chart illustrating an example of retraining based on data uncertainty value in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(20) FIG. 17 is a diagram illustrating a measurement data range in method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

(21) Various example embodiments will be described more fully hereinafter with reference to the accompanying drawings, in which some example embodiments are shown. In the drawings, like numerals refer to like elements throughout. The repeated descriptions may be omitted.

(22) FIG. 1 is a flowchart illustrating a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device based on deep learning according to some example embodiments. At least a portion of the method may be performed by, e.g., at least one processor executing program codes. The program codes may be stored in computer readable media. The computer readable media may be, for example, a non-transistor computer readable media. The term “non-transitory,” as used herein, is a description of the medium itself (e.g., as tangible, and not a signal) as opposed to a limitation on data storage persistency (e.g., RAM vs. ROM).

(23) Referring to FIG. 1, a simulation current-voltage curve may be generated using a plurality of compact models (S100). Each of the plurality of compact models may generate simulation result data by performing a simulation based on device data such that the simulation result data may indicate characteristics of semiconductor devices corresponding to the device data.

(24) As will be described below with reference to FIGS. 7 and 8, the plurality of compact models may respectively correspond to a plurality of process data and a plurality of semiconductor products. As will be described below with reference to FIG. 9, each of the compact models corresponding to process data and a semiconductor product may generate the simulation result data indicating characteristics of a semiconductor device corresponding to the device data by performing a simulation based on the device data. In some example embodiments, the compact

model may generate the simulation current-voltage curve as the simulation result data. In some example embodiments, the compact model may generate a drain current corresponding to voltages (such as a gate voltage and a drain voltage) as the simulation result data. For example, the simulation current-voltage curve may be generated based on drain currents output from the compact model where the drain currents are obtained by changing the voltages that are input to the compact model. As will be described below with reference to FIG. 10, the device data may indicate, e.g., structure and operation condition of the semiconductor device and the process data may indicate, e.g., condition of manufacturing process of the semiconductor device.

(25) A plurality of simulation reference points on the simulation current-voltage curve may be extracted (**S200**). The number and positions on the curve of the plurality of simulation reference points may be determined based on the characteristics of the semiconductor device.

(26) Basic training data corresponding to a combination of the plurality of simulation reference points and the simulation current-voltage curve may be generated (**S300**).

(27) A deep learning model may be trained based on the basic training data such that the deep learning model outputs a prediction current-voltage curve (**S400**). As will be described below with reference to FIG. 10, the simulation current-voltage curve and the prediction current-voltage curve may indicate electrical characteristics of the semiconductor device.

(28) A target prediction current-voltage curve of the semiconductor device included in the target semiconductor product may be generated based on the deep learning model and a plurality of target reference points corresponding to the target semiconductor product (**S500**). As will be described below with reference to FIGS. 7 and 8, the target semiconductor product may be a new semiconductor product (e.g., a semiconductor product that is not included in the plurality of semiconductor products corresponding to the plurality of compact models).

(29) As such, the method and the computing device according to some example embodiments may efficiently predict the characteristics of the semiconductor device included in the new semiconductor product, by generating the basic training data corresponding to the combinations of the simulation reference points and the simulation current-voltage curve using the established compact models corresponding to the previous semiconductor products and training the deep learning model based on the basic training data. Through the enhanced prediction performance of the deep learning model the time and/or the cost of designing and manufacturing the semiconductor product including the semiconductor device and the performance of the semiconductor product may be enhanced.

(30) FIG. 2 is a block diagram illustrating a computing device according to some example embodiments.

(31) Referring to FIG. 2, a computing device **100** may include processors **110**, a random access memory **120**, a device driver **130**, a storage device **140**, a modem **150**, and a user interface **160**.

(32) At least one processor of the processors **110** may be configured to operate a deep learning module DLM **220** and a training control module TCM **240**. The training control module **240** may perform the method of FIG. 1 to train the deep learning model **220**.

(33) In some example embodiments, the deep learning model **220** and the training control module **240** may be implemented as instructions (and/or program codes) that may be executed by the at least one of the processors **110**. The instructions (and/or program codes) of the deep learning model **220** and the training control module **240** may be stored in computer readable media. For example, the at least one processor may load (and/or read) the instructions to (and/or from) the random access memory **120** and/or the storage device **140**.

(34) In some example embodiments, the at least one processor may be manufactured to efficiently execute instructions included in the deep learning model **220** and the training control module **240**. For example, the at least one processor may be a dedicated processor that is implemented (e.g. in hardware) based on the deep learning model **220** and the training control module **240**. The at least one processor may efficiently execute instructions from various machine learning modules. In

some embodiments, the at least one processor may receive information corresponding to the deep learning model **220** and the training control module **240** to operate the deep learning model **220** and the training control module **240**.

(35) The processors **110** may include, for example, at least one general-purpose processor such as a central processing unit (CPU) **111**, an application processor (AP) **112**, and/or other processing units. In addition, the processors **110** may include at least one special-purpose processor such as a neural processing unit (NPU) **113**, a neuromorphic processor (NP) **114**, a graphic processing unit (GPU) **115**, etc. For example, the processors **110** may include two or more heterogeneous processors. Though the processors **110** are illustrated as including the CPU **111**, AP **112**, NPU **113**, NP **114**, and GPU **115**, the example embodiments are not so limited. For example, the processors **110** may include more or fewer processors than illustrated.

(36) The random access memory **120** may be used as an operation memory of the processors **110**, a main memory, and/or a system memory of the computing device **100**. The random access memory **120** may include a volatile memory such as a dynamic random access memory (DRAM), a static random access memory (SRAM), and/or the like. Additionally (and/or alternatively), the random access memory **120** may include a nonvolatile memory such as a phase-change random access memory (PRAM), a ferroelectrics random access memory (FRAM), a magnetic random access memory (MRAM), a resistive random access memory (RRAM), and/or the like.

(37) The device driver **130** may control peripheral circuits such as the storage device **140**, the modem **150**, the user interface **160**, etc., according to requests of the processors **110**. The storage device **140** may include a fixed storage device such as a hard disk drive, a solid state drive (SSD), etc., and/or include (and/or be connected to) an attachable storage device such as an external hard disk drive, an external SSD, a memory card, and/or other external storage.

(38) The modem **150** may perform wired and/or wireless communication with external devices through various communication methods and/or communication interface protocols such as Ethernet, WiFi, LTE, a third generation communication system such as code division multiple access (CDMA), global system for mobile communications (GSM), north American digital cellular (NADC), extended-time division multiple access (E-TDMA), and/or wide band code division multiple access (WCDMA), a fourth generation communication system such as 4G LTE, a fifth generation communication system such as 5G mobile communication, and/or other communication methods.

(39) The user interface **160** may receive information from a user and provide information to the user. The user interface **160** may include at least one output interface such as a display **161**, a speaker **162**, etc., and may further include at least one input interface such as mice (or a mouse) **163**, a keyboard **164**, a touch input device **165**, etc. Though illustrated as including the display **161**, the speaker **162**, the mice **163**, the keyboard **164**, and the touch input device **165**, the example embodiments are not so limited, and may, e.g., include more or fewer elements. In some example embodiments, for example, some of the user interfaces **160** may be combined (e.g., to include a touch screen and/or the like).

(40) In some example embodiments, the deep learning model **220** and the training control module **240** may receive the instructions (and/or program codes) through the modem **150** and store the instructions in the storage device **150**. In some example embodiments, the instructions of the deep learning model **220** and the training control module **240** may be stored in an attachable storage device and the attachable storage device may be connected to the computing device **100** by a user. The instructions of the deep learning model **220** and the training control module **240** may be loaded in the random access memory **120** for rapid execution of the instructions.

(41) In some example embodiments, at least one of the computer program codes, the compact model, the deep learning model and/or the training control module may be stored in a transitory and/or non-transitory computer-readable medium. In some example embodiments, values resulting from a simulation performed by the processor and/or values obtained from arithmetic processing

performed by the processor may be stored in a transitory and/or non-transitory computer-readable medium. In some example embodiments, intermediate values generated during deep learning may be stored in a transitory and/or non-transitory computer-readable medium. In some example embodiments, at least one of the training data, the process data, the device data, the simulation result data, the prediction current-voltage curve, and/or the uncertainty data may be stored in a transitory and/or non-transitory computer-readable medium. However, the example embodiments are not limited thereto.

(42) FIG. 3 is a block diagram electronic device according to some example embodiments.

(43) Referring to FIG. 3, an electronic device **1000** may include an input unit **11**, a storage **12**, and a processor **13**. The storage **12** may include a compact model CM. The electronic device **1000**, a semiconductor manufacturing equipment **31**, and a semiconductor measuring equipment **32** may form a semiconductor system. In some example embodiments, the electronic device **1000** may be implemented as a semiconductor system separated from the semiconductor manufacturing equipment **31** and the semiconductor measuring equipment **32**.

(44) The input unit **11** may receive the device data and transmit the device data to processor **13**, and the processor **13** may generate the basic training data using the compact model MD. The compact model MD may provide the simulation result data indicating the characteristics of the semiconductor device corresponding to the device data by performing simulation based on the device data. The simulation result data may be the simulation current-voltage curve, or the simulation current-voltage curve may be generated based on the simulation result data.

(45) The processor **13** may extract the plurality of simulation reference points on the simulation current-voltage curve and generate the training data corresponding to a combination of the plurality of simulation reference points and the simulation current-voltage curve. The processor **13** may obtain various simulation current-voltage curves and corresponding simulation reference points and establish a database DB including various combinations of the plurality of simulation reference points and the simulation current-voltage curve. The established database DB may be stored in the storage **12**, and the processor **13** may perform training or learning of the deep learning model DLM using the training data in the database DB.

(46) The processor **13** may generate (and/or update) the compact model CM based on measurement data MD and store the compact model CM in the storage **12**.

(47) The compact model CM may be generated (and/or updated) based on the measurement data MD. The measurement data MD may include an electrical and/or structural characteristic of a semiconductor product actually measured by the semiconductor measuring equipment **32**. The semiconductor product measured by the semiconductor measuring equipment **32** may have been manufactured by the semiconductor manufacturing equipment **31** based on semiconductor manufacturing data. The semiconductor manufacturing data may be related to a manufacture of a target semiconductor device and/or a manufacture of a semiconductor device similar to the target semiconductor device.

(48) For example, the compact model CM may be updated in response to the measurement of an electrical and/or structural characteristic of a semiconductor product by the semiconductor measuring equipment **32**. For example, in response to the reception of the measurement data MD from the semiconductor measuring equipment **32**, the processor **13** may update the compact model CM to reflect the latest measurement data MD. The processor **13** may receive the measurement data MD from the semiconductor measuring equipment **32** through the input unit **11** or a communication unit.

(49) The storage **12** may include equipment information of at least one selected from the semiconductor manufacturing equipment **31** and/or the semiconductor measuring equipment **32**. For example, a semiconductor product may have a different electrical and/or structural characteristic according to the type of the semiconductor manufacturing equipment **31**. In addition, the electrical and/or structural characteristic of a semiconductor product may be differently

measured according to the type of the semiconductor measuring equipment **32**. To reduce the potential for errors involved in the types of the semiconductor manufacturing equipment **31** and the semiconductor measuring equipment **32**, the storage **12** may include various kinds of equipment information such as information about a manufacturer of the semiconductor manufacturing equipment **31** and/or a manufacturer of the semiconductor measuring equipment **32**, model information of the semiconductor manufacturing equipment **31** and the semiconductor measuring equipment **32**, and/or performance information thereof. The processor **13** may update the compact model CM with reference to the equipment information stored in the storage **12**.

(50) The processor **13** may use the deep learning model DLM, the compact model CM, and/or the databased DB to simulate and/or predict the performance of a semiconductor device manufactured by the semiconductor manufacturing equipment **31**, e.g., before the semiconductor device is manufactured. The processor **13** may, for example, determine how a change to the design of the semiconductor device may change the current-voltage characteristics of the semiconductor device. In some example embodiments, for example, the processor **13** may confirm a design based on these predictions thereby indicating that the design is okay to proceed to manufacturing and/or forwarding the design to a processor controlling the semiconductor manufacturing equipment **31**. The semiconductor manufacturing equipment **31** may then manufacture a semiconductor device based on the confirmed design. The processor **13** may also pause (and/or stop) the production of semiconductor devices based on the design if, e.g., the change in the design would result in the current-voltage characteristics of the semiconductor devices deteriorating below a threshold value. In some example embodiments a warning and/or a representation of how the current-voltage characteristics are affected by the change in the design may be provided to a user (e.g., through the user interfaces **160** and/or the modem **150** of FIG. 2).

(51) In some example embodiments, the processor **13** may also (e.g., periodically) confirm the prediction of the deep learning model DLM by comparing the prediction of a design with a semiconductor device manufactured based on the design, e.g., by using the measurement data MD received from the semiconductor measuring equipment **32** and/or using a data uncertainty value, as discussed below. For example, in some example embodiments, the processor **13** may store the prediction (e.g., in the storage **12**), and then may compare the prediction to the semiconductor device manufactured based on the design. If the prediction and the manufactured semiconductor device differ, e.g., beyond a permissible threshold, the compact model CM stored in the storage **12** may be, e.g., updated based on the measurement data MD actually measured by the semiconductor measuring equipment **32**, as discussed above.

(52) FIG. 4A is a diagram illustrating an example of a simulation current-voltage curve and a plurality of simulation reference points in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(53) Hereinafter, some example embodiments are described based on a case that the semiconductor device is a transistor and the simulation current-voltage curve and the simulation current-voltage curve indicates a change of a drain current of the transistor according to a change of a gate voltage of the transistor with respect to a drain voltage of the transistor, but example embodiments are not limited thereto and may be applied to other semiconductor devices (e.g., two-terminal devices like diodes, three-terminal devices like rectifiers, four-terminal devices like optocouplers, electronic components of other types mimicking and/or coupled to semiconductor devices (e.g., microelectromechanical systems (MEMS), resistors, capacitors, integrated cells, etc.), and/or the like). For example, the semiconductor device may be replaced with a MOS capacitor and/or the current-voltage curve may be replaced with a capacitance-voltage curve.

(54) In some example embodiments, as illustrated in FIG. 4A, the simulation current-voltage curve IVC may include a plurality of gate voltage curves respectively corresponding to a plurality of gate voltages V_{g1} , V_{g2} and V_{g3} . The plurality of simulation reference points PNT may be extracted such that the plurality of simulation reference points may be distributed on the plurality of gate

voltage curves. FIG. 4A illustrates an example of first through ninth simulation reference points P1~P9, however the number and the positions on the curves of the simulation reference points may be determined based, e.g., on the characteristics of the semiconductor device.

(55) Each of the first through ninth simulation reference points P1~P9 may correspond to a combination [Vd, Vg, Id] of the drain voltage Vd, the gate voltage Vg and the drain current Id. The values of the drain voltage Vd and the gate voltage Vg for the simulation reference points may be fixed and the corresponding drain current Id may be obtained using the simulation current-voltage curve IVC.

(56) FIG. 4B is a diagram for describing training of a deep learning model in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(57) In FIG. 4B, the dotted curves indicate the simulation current-voltage curves IVC of FIG. 4A, and the solid curves indicate the prediction current-voltage curves PIVC that are output from the deep learning model. While the deep learning model is trained, the prediction current-voltage curve PIVC may deviate from the simulation current-voltage curve IVC. The prediction performance of the deep learning model may be enhanced as the deviation is decreased.

(58) As the training of the deep learning model is progressed, the prediction current-voltage curve PIVC may approach the simulation current-voltage curve IVC. It may be determined that the training of the deep learning model is completed when the deviation between the prediction current-voltage curve PIVC and the simulation current-voltage curve IVC becomes smaller than a predetermined (and/or otherwise determined) threshold value. The prediction performance of the trained deep learning model may be enhanced as the amount of the basic training data is increased.

(59) FIG. 4C is a diagram illustrating an example of a target current-voltage curve and a plurality of target reference points in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(60) Referring to FIG. 4C, after the training of the deep learning model is completed (e.g., after the deep learning model is trained such that the prediction performance of the deep learning model is higher than a target performance) the target prediction current-voltage curve PIVC may be generated by applying the plurality of target reference points TPNT to the trained deep learning model.

(61) In FIG. 4C, the dotted curves indicate the simulation current-voltage curves IVC of FIG. 4A, and the solid curves indicate the target prediction current-voltage curves PIVC that are output from the trained deep learning model.

(62) As illustrated in FIG. 4C, the number of the target reference points TPNT may be equal to the number of the simulation reference points PNT. For example, when the plurality of simulation reference points are determined as the first through ninth simulation reference points P1~P9, the plurality of target reference points may include first through ninth target reference points TP1~TP9 respectively corresponding to the first through ninth simulation reference points.

(63) The combination [Vd, Vg] of the drain voltage Vd and the gate voltage Vg corresponding to each target reference point TPNT may be equal to the combination [Vd, Vg] of the drain voltage Vd and the gate voltage Vg corresponding to each simulation reference point PNT. For example, the drain voltage Vd and the gate voltage of the first target reference point TP1 may be equal to the drain voltage Vd and the gate voltage of the first simulation reference point P1, the drain voltage Vd and the gate voltage of the second target reference point TP2 may be equal to the drain voltage Vd and the gate voltage of the second simulation reference point P2, and in this way the drain voltage Vd and the gate voltage of the ninth target reference point TP9 may be equal to the drain voltage Vd and the gate voltage of the ninth simulation reference point P9.

(64) Non-supervised learning is an algorithm such that the deep learning model is trained while the ground-truth data are unknown, and recently the non-supervised learning is being researched intensively. A representative example of the non-supervised learning is the generative adversarial network (GAN). The GAN predicts a probability distribution of original data and in this aspect the

GAN is differentiated from the non-supervised learning based on simple clustering.

(65) In general, the GAN may include a discriminator model for discrimination and a generator model for regression generation. The generator model and the discriminator model contend mutually to improve the opponent's performance. As the competition is progressed, the generator model may generate the fake data that is not distinguishable from the true data, and the GAN may generate the probability distribution that is substantially the same as the probability distribution of the original data. For example, the discrimination value D generated by the discriminator model may approach 0.5, which indicates that further discrimination would be meaningless and/or ineffective.

(66) The learning of the discriminator model may include two processes. The first process may be to input the true data to the discriminator model and train the discriminator model to determine the input data as the true data, and the second process may be to input the fake data to the discriminator model and train the discriminator model to determine the input data as the fake data. Through the two processes, the discriminator model may be trained to discriminate the true data and the fake data.

(67) The performance of both of the discriminator model and the generator model may be enhanced through the mutual content. As a result the generator model may generate the perfect fake data and the discriminator model cannot distinguish the fake data from the true data.

(68) For example, the GAN may be trained to solve the following problem or equation using an object function $V(D, G)$

$$(69) \min_G \max_D V(D, G) = E_{x \sim p_{\text{data}}(x)} [\log D(x)] + E_{z \sim p_z(z)} [\log(1 - D(G(z)))]$$

(70) In the above equation, $x \sim p_{\text{data}}(x)$ indicates sampled data from the probability distribution of the real data and $z \sim p_z(z)$ indicates sampled data from arbitrary noise using a general Gaussian distribution. “ z ” is referred to as a latent vector that is a vector in a reduced dimension to describe the data conveniently. The discrimination value $D(x)$ is between 0 and 1. The discrimination value $D(x)$ is 1 when the data x is true, and the discrimination value $D(x)$ is 0 when the data x is fake. The discrimination value $D(G(z))$ is 1 when the discriminator model determines that the data $G(z)$ generated by the generator model is true, and the discrimination value $D(G(z))$ is 0 when the discriminator model determines that the data $G(z)$ is fake.

(71) To maximize the object function $V(D, G)$ by the discriminator model, both of the first item and the second item in the above equation are maximized (and/or increased), that is, both of $\log D(x)$ and $\log(1 - D(G(z)))$ have to be maximized (and/or increased). Accordingly, in some example embodiments, $D(x)$ has to be 1, which indicates that the discriminator model is trained to determine the real data as the true data. For example, training the GAN to maximize the object function $V(D, G)$ indicates training the discriminator mode to determine the true data as the true data and the fake data as the fake data.

(72) To minimize the object function $V(D, G)$ by the generator model, the second item (e.g., $\log(1 - D(G(z)))$) is minimized such that the first item is irrelevant to the generator model. Accordingly, in some example embodiments, $\log(1 - D(G(z)))$ is 0 and $D(G(z))$ is 1, which indicates training the generator model to generate the perfect fake data that cannot be discriminated by the discriminator model.

(73) As such, training the discriminator model to maximize the object function $V(D, G)$ and the generator model to minimize the object model $V(D, G)$ may be referred to as a “minmax” problem.

(74) FIG. 5 is a diagram illustrating an example of a deep learning model in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(75) Referring to FIG. 5, a deep learning model DLM may be implemented as a generative adversarial network (GAN) as described above. For example, the deep learning model DLM may include a generator model GEN and a discriminator model DCMN.

(76) The generator model GEN may output the prediction current-voltage curve PIVC based on the

plurality of simulation reference points PNT. The discriminator model DCMN may output a discrimination value D based on the simulation current-voltage curve IVC and the prediction current-voltage curve PIVC such that the discrimination value D indicates similarity between the simulation current-voltage curve IVC and the prediction current-voltage curve PIVC.

(77) As described above, in some example embodiments, the discrimination value D may approach 0 as the prediction current-voltage curve PIVC further differentiates from the simulation current-voltage curve IVC and the discrimination value D may approach 1 as the prediction current-voltage curve PIVC further approximates towards the simulation current-voltage curve IVC. In some example embodiments, the training control module **240** in FIG. 2 may train the deep learning model DLM such that the discrimination value D approaches 0.5.

(78) FIGS. 6A and 6B are diagrams for describing examples of a deep learning neural network structure that is driven by a machine learning device according to some example embodiments.

(79) Referring to FIG. 6A, a general neural network may include an input layer IL, a plurality of hidden layers HL1, HL2, . . . , HL n and an output layer OL.

(80) The input layer IL may include i input nodes $x_1, x_2, \dots, x_i$, where i is a natural number. Input data (e.g., vector input data) X whose length is i may be input to the input nodes $x_1, x_2, \dots, x_i$ such that each element of the input data X is input to a respective one of the input nodes $x_1, x_2, \dots, x_i$.

(81) The plurality of hidden layers HL1, HL2, HL n may include n hidden layers, where n is a natural number, and may include a plurality of hidden nodes $h_{sup.1.sub.1}, h_{sup.1.sub.2}, h_{sup.1.sub.3}, \dots, h_{sup.2.sub.1}, h_{sup.2.sub.2}, h_{sup.2.sub.3}, \dots, h_{sup.2.sub.m}, h_{sup.n.sub.1}, h_{sup.n.sub.2}, h_{sup.n.sub.3}, \dots, h_{sup.n.sub.m}$. For example, the hidden layer HL1 may include m hidden nodes $h_{sup.1.sub.1}, h_{sup.1.sub.2}, h_{sup.1.sub.3}, \dots, h_{sup.1.sub.m}$, the hidden layer HL2 may include m hidden nodes $h_{sup.2.sub.1}, h_{sup.2.sub.2}, h_{sup.2.sub.3}, \dots, h_{sup.2.sub.m}$, and the hidden layer HL n may include m hidden nodes $h_{sup.n.sub.1}, h_{sup.n.sub.2}, h_{sup.n.sub.3}, \dots, h_{sup.n.sub.m}$, where m is a natural number.

(82) The output layer OL may include j output nodes $y_1, y_2, \dots, y_j$, providing output data Y where j is a natural number. The output layer OL may output the output data Y associated with the input data X .

(83) A structure of the neural network illustrated in FIG. 6A may be represented by information on branches (or connections) between nodes illustrated as lines, and a weighted value assigned to each branch. Nodes within one layer may not be connected to one another, but nodes of different layers may be fully (and/or partially) connected to one another.

(84) Each node (e.g., the node $h_{sup.1.sub.1}$) may receive an output of a previous node (e.g., the node $x_{sub.1}$), may perform a computing operation, computation and/or calculation on the received output, and may output a result of the computing operation, computation, or calculation as an output to a next node (e.g., the node $h_{sup.2.sub.1}$). Each node may calculate a value to be output by applying the input to a specific function, e.g., a nonlinear function.

(85) Generally, the structure of the neural network may be set in advance, and the weighted values for the connections between the nodes are set appropriately using data having an already known answer of which class the data belongs to. The data with the already known answer may be referred to as “training data,” and a process of determining the weighted value is referred to as “training.” The neural network “learns” during the training process. A group of an independently trainable structure and the weighted value is referred to as a “model,” and a process of predicting, by the model with the determined weighted value, which class the input data belongs to, and then outputting the predicted value, is referred to as a “testing” process.

(86) The general neural network illustrated in FIG. 6A may not be suitable for and/or inefficient for some operations, such as handling input image data (or input sound data), because each node (e.g., the node $h_{sup.1.sub.1}$) is connected to all nodes of a previous layer (e.g., the nodes $x_1, x_2, \dots, x_i$ included in the layer IL) and then the number of weighted values drastically increases as the size of

the input image data increases. Thus, a convolutional neural network (CNN), which is implemented by combining the filtering technique with the general neural network, has been researched such that two-dimensional image (e.g., the input image data) is efficiently trained by the convolutional neural network.

(87) Referring to FIG. 6B, a convolutional neural network may include a plurality of layers CONV1, RELU1, CONV2, RELU2, POOL1, CONV3, RELU3, CONV4, RELU4, POOL2, CONV5, RELU5, CONV6, RELU6, POOL3 and FC.

(88) Unlike the general neural network, each layer of the convolutional neural network may have three dimensions of width, height, and depth, and thus data that is input to each layer may be volume data having three dimensions of width, height, and depth.

(89) Each of convolutional layers CONV1, CONV2, CONV3, CONV4, CONV5 and CONV6 may perform a convolutional operation on input volume data. In an image processing, the convolutional operation represents an operation in which image data is processed based on a mask with weighted values and an output value is obtained by multiplying input values by the weighted values and adding up the total multiplied values. The mask may be referred to as a filter, window, and/or kernel.

(90) For example, parameters of each convolutional layer may comprise (and/or include) a set of learnable filters. Every filter may be spatially small (e.g., along width and height), but may extend through the full depth of an input volume. For example, during the forward pass, each filter may be slid (e.g., convolved) across the width and height of the input volume, and dot products may be computed between the entries of the filter and the input at any position. As the filter is slid over the width and height of the input volume, a two-dimensional activation map that gives the responses of that filter at every spatial position may be generated. As a result, an output volume may be generated by stacking these activation maps along the depth dimension. For example, if input volume data having a size of $32 \times 32 \times 3$ passes through the convolutional layer CONV1 having four filters with zero-padding, output volume data of the convolutional layer CONV1 may have a size of $32 \times 32 \times 12$ (e.g., a depth of volume data increases).

(91) Each of the rectifying linear unit ("RELU") layers RELU1, RELU2, RELU3, RELU4, RELU5 and RELU6 may perform a rectified linear unit operation that corresponds to an activation function defined by, e.g., a function $f(x) = \max(0, x)$ (e.g., an output is zero for all negative input x). For example, if input volume data having a size of $32 \times 32 \times 12$ passes through the RELU layer RELU1 to perform the rectified linear unit operation, output volume data of the RELU layer RELU1 may have a size of $32 \times 32 \times 12$ (e.g., a size of volume data is maintained).

(92) Each of pooling layers POOL1, POOL2 and POOL3 may perform a down-sampling operation on input volume data along spatial dimensions of width and height. For example, four input values arranged in a 2×2 matrix formation may be converted into one output value based on a 2×2 filter. For example, a maximum value of four input values arranged in a 2×2 matrix formation may be selected based on 2×2 maximum pooling, or an average value of four input values arranged in a 2×2 matrix formation may be obtained based on 2×2 average pooling. For example, if input volume data having a size of $32 \times 32 \times 12$ passes through the pooling layer POOL1 having a 2×2 filter, output volume data of the pooling layer POOL1 may have a size of $16 \times 16 \times 12$ (e.g., width and height of volume data decreases, and a depth of volume data is maintained).

(93) Typically, one convolutional layer (e.g., CONV1) and one RELU layer (e.g., RELU1) may form a pair of CONV/RELU layers in the convolutional neural network, pairs of the CONV/RELU layers may be repeatedly arranged in the convolutional neural network, and the pooling layer may be periodically inserted in the convolutional neural network, thereby reducing characteristics of the input data X . The type and number of layers including in the convolution neural network may be changed variously.

(94) Though the GNN and CNN are provided as examples of neural networks for deep learning models, the example embodiments of the deep learning model are not limited to a specific neural

network. The deep learning model may include, for example, at least one of GAN (Generative Adversarial Network), CNN (Convolution Neural Network), R-CNN (Region with Convolution Neural Network), RPN (Region Proposal Network), RNN (Recurrent Neural Network), S-DNN (Stacking-based deep Neural Network), S-SDNN (State-Space Dynamic Neural Network), Deconvolution Network, DBN (Deep Belief Network), RBM (Restricted Boltzmann Machine), Fully Convolutional Network, LSTM (Long Short-Term Memory) Network, Classification Network and BNN (Bayesian Neural Network). Additionally (and/or alternatively), the deep learning model(s) may be trained based on at least one of various algorithms such as regression, linear and/or logistic regression, random forest, a support vector machine (SVM), and/or other types of models, such as statistical clustering, Bayesian classification, decision trees, dimensionality reduction such as principal component analysis, expert systems, and/or combinations thereof including ensembles such as random forests.

(95) FIG. 6C is a diagram illustrating an example of a node included in a neural network.

(96) FIG. 6C illustrates an example node operation performed by a node ND in a neural network. When N inputs $a_1 \sim a_n$ are provided to the node ND, the node ND may multiply the n inputs $a_1 \sim a_n$ and corresponding n weights $w_1 \sim w_n$, respectively, may sum n values obtained by the multiplication, may add an offset “ b ” to a summed value, and may generate one output value by applying a value to which the offset “ b ” is added to a specific function “ σ ”. The learning operation may be performed based on the training data to update all nodes in the neural network.

(97) In cases of prediction of the characteristics of a semiconductor device based on deep learning, a sufficient amount of training data and/or learning data may be utilized in (and/or required for) training of a deep learning model and/or deep learning module. For example, tens through millions of training data of various kinds may be utilized in (and/or required for) preventing over-fitting during training and enhance performance of the deep learning model. According to some example embodiments, the database for training the deep learning model may be established efficiently by generating the training data using the compact model.

(98) FIGS. 7 and 8 are diagrams for describing relationship between a plurality of semiconductor products and a target semiconductor product in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(99) Referring to FIGS. 7 and 8, the process data PR may be determined depending on a process-group combination PGC of a process type PT indicating a manufacturing process of each semiconductor product SP and a product group PG in which each semiconductor product SP is included. For example, the process type PT may indicate a critical dimension (CD) of the manufacturing process. The product group PG may include a server product group, a mobile product group, a graphic product group, a high bandwidth memory product group, and/or the like.

(100) A first semiconductor product SP1 may correspond to a first process-product combination CB1 of a first process type PT1 and a first product group PG1, and the process data PR of the first semiconductor product SP1 may be determined as first process data PR1. A second semiconductor product SP2 may correspond to a second process-product combination CB2 of the first process type PT1 and a second product group PG2, and the process data PR of the second semiconductor product SP2 may be determined as second process data PR2. A third semiconductor product SP3 may correspond to a third process-product combination CB3 of the first process type PT1 and a third product group PG3, and the process data PR of the third semiconductor product SP3 may be determined as third process data PR3.

(101) A fourth semiconductor product SP4 may correspond to a fourth process-product combination CB4 of a second process type PT2 and the first product group PG1, and the process data PR of the fourth semiconductor product SP4 may be determined as fourth process data PR4. A fifth semiconductor product SP5 may correspond to a fifth process-product combination CB5 of the second process type PT2 and the second product group PG2, and the process data PR of the fifth semiconductor product SP5 may be determined as fifth process data PR5. A sixth semiconductor

product SP6 may correspond to a sixth process-product combination CB6 of the second process type PT2 and the third product group PG3, and the process data PR of the sixth semiconductor product SP6 may be determined as sixth process data PR6.

(102) A seventh semiconductor product SP7 may correspond to a seventh process-product combination CB7 of a third process type PT3 and the first product group PG1, and the process data PR of the seventh semiconductor product SP7 may be determined as seventh process data PR7. An eighth semiconductor product SP8 may correspond to an eighth process-product combination CB8 of the third process type PT3 and the third product group PG3, and the process data PR of the eighth semiconductor product SP8 may be determined as eighth process data PR8.

(103) The measurement data MD may be provided with respect to each of the first through eighth semiconductor products SP1-SP8 as described with reference to FIG. 3, and first through eighth compact models CM1~CM8 respectively corresponding to the first through eighth semiconductor products SP1-SP8 may be generated. The above-described basic training data may be generated using the first through eighth compact models CM1~CM8. The first through eighth semiconductor products SP1-SP8 may be the previous or established semiconductor products ESP, that is, the plurality of semiconductor products described with reference to FIG. 1.

(104) A ninth semiconductor product SP9 may correspond to a ninth process-product combination CB9 of the third process type PT3 and the second product group PG2, and the process data PR of the ninth semiconductor product SP9 may be determined as ninth process data PR9.

(105) The ninth semiconductor product SP9 may be in a stage of designing in which a compact model corresponding to the ninth semiconductor product SP9 is not generated yet, whereas the first through eighth semiconductor products SP1~SP8 have the established compact models CM1~CM8.

(106) As such, the process data PT may be determined depending on the process-group combination PGC of the process type PT indicating the manufacturing process of each semiconductor product SP and the product group PG in which each semiconductor product SP is included, and the process-group combination (e.g., the ninth process-group combination CB9) of the target semiconductor product (e.g., the ninth semiconductor product SP9) may be a new process-group combination that is not included in the process-group combinations (e.g., the first through eighth process-group combinations CB1~CB8) of the plurality of previous semiconductor products (e.g., the first through eighth semiconductor products SP1~SP8). For example, the target semiconductor product (e.g., the ninth semiconductor product SP9) may be a new semiconductor product that is not included in the plurality of previous semiconductor products (e.g., the first through eighth semiconductor products SP1~SP8) respectively corresponding to the plurality of established compact models (CM1~CM8).

(107) The compact models are configured to provide the characteristics of semiconductor device within the range of the device data utilized in (and/or required) for designing. For example, the test element groups may be disposed scribe lanes of a wafer to provide the measurement data for generating the compact models. However, there may exist time increases and/or difficulties in securing coverage of data range to generate the compact modes, due to limited area of the scribe lanes, process turn-around-time (TAT), and so on.

(108) According to some example embodiments, the characteristics of the semiconductor device included in the target semiconductor product (e.g., the ninth semiconductor product SP9) may be provided efficiently and rapidly by providing the database of the basic training data for training the deep learning model using the established compact models (e.g., the first through eighth compact models CM1~CM8) of the previously developed semiconductor products (e.g., the first through eighth semiconductor products SP1~SP8).

(109) The plurality of previous semiconductor products and the target semiconductor product may be (and/or be included in) memory devices. Some example embodiments are particularly useful in predicting the characteristics of the memory devices. In the memory business, the design technology co-optimization (DTCO) becomes more significant, e.g., providing device models

rapidly for designing memory devices of next generations. In addition, the identical and/or similar semiconductor devices of the previous generation are used as the shrunk form in the next generation with respect to the memory devices, and thus the database for a new memory device may be efficiently established using the established compact models of the previous memory devices.

(110) FIG. 9 is a diagram illustrating an example of a deep learning model in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments. For convenience of illustration, the detailed configuration of a deep learning model is omitted and only the input layer IL receiving input data X and the output layer OL providing output data Y are illustrated in FIG. 9.

(111) The compact model may provide simulation result data SR indicating characteristics of a semiconductor device corresponding to device data DV by performing simulation based on the device data DV. In general, each compact model may be designed to output the simulation result data SR corresponding to process data associated a specific semiconductor product.

(112) Referring to FIG. 9, deep learning model DLM1 may be generated using a plurality of compact models CM1~CM8 respectively corresponding to a plurality of process data PR1-PR8.

(113) The basic training data TRD may be generated using the plurality of compact models CM1~CM8 such that the basic training data TRD correspond to a combination of a plurality of simulation reference points PNT and a simulation current-voltage curve IVC. A plurality of basic training data TRD corresponding to different combinations may be generated based on different values of the process data PR and the device data DV.

(114) In the example of FIG. 9, the input data X of the deep learning model DLM1 may include the plurality of simulation reference points PNT. The output data Y may include the prediction current-voltage curve PIVC. The supervised learning of the deep learning model MLM1 may be performed using the simulation current-voltage curve IVC as the ground-truth data of the prediction current-voltage curve PIVC with respect to the input of the plurality of simulation reference points PNT.

(115) FIG. 10 is a diagram illustrating data in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments. FIG. 10 illustrates example data when a semiconductor device corresponds to a transistor. However, as noted above, the example embodiments are not limited to transistors and may be applied to semiconductor devices of other types.

(116) Referring to FIG. 10, input data X of a compact model may include device data DV and/or process data PR. The input data of the deep learning model may include the plurality of simulation reference points as described above.

(117) The device data DV may indicate structure and operation condition of the semiconductor device. For example, the device data DV may include information on the structure of the semiconductor device such as a width W of a transistor, a length L of the transistor, and so on. In addition, the device data DV may include information of the operation condition of the semiconductor device such as an operation temperature Top of the transistor, a drain voltage Vd, a gate voltage Vg, a body voltage Vb, a source voltage Vs of the transistor, and so on.

(118) The process data PR may indicate condition of manufacturing process of the semiconductor device. For example, the process data PR may include a kind Dk of a dopant in an ion-implanting process, a density Dd of the dopant, an activation temperature Tact, a thickness tOG of a gate oxide layer, a thickness of a spacer tSP in a gate structure of the transistor, and so on.

(119) Output data of the compact model may include simulation result data SR. The above described simulation current-voltage curve IVC may be generated based on the simulation result data SR. In some example embodiments, as will be described below with reference to FIGS. 11 through 13, the output data of the deep learning model may include uncertainty data UC in addition to the prediction current-voltage curve PIVC.

(120) The simulation result data SR may indicate electrical characteristics of the semiconductor

device. For example, the simulation result data SR may include a threshold voltage V_t , a gain G , a breakdown voltage V_{bk} , a drain current I_d of the transistor, and so on.

(121) The uncertainty data UC may indicate uncertainty of the prediction data, e.g., the prediction current-voltage curve PIVC. The uncertainty data UC may include a model uncertainty value U_m and/or a data uncertainty value U_d . As will be described below, the model uncertainty value U_m may indicate the uncertainty of the prediction data caused by insufficiency of the basic training data, and the data uncertainty value U_d may indicate the uncertainty of the prediction data caused by noises of the basic training data.

(122) FIG. 11 is a flowchart illustrating a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments. At least a portion of the method may be performed by executing program codes by at least one processor and the program codes may be stored in computer readable media.

(123) Referring to FIG. 11, a simulation current-voltage curve may be generated using a plurality of compact models (S101). Each of the plurality of compact models may generate simulation result data by performing a simulation based on device data such that the simulation result data may indicate characteristics of semiconductor devices corresponding to the device data.

(124) As described below with reference to FIGS. 7 and 8, the plurality of compact models may respectively correspond to a plurality of process data and a plurality of semiconductor products. As described below with reference to FIG. 9, each compact model corresponding to each process data and each semiconductor product may generate the simulation result data indicating characteristics of a semiconductor device corresponding to the device data by performing a simulation based on the device data. In some example embodiments, the compact model may generate the simulation current-voltage curve as the simulation result data. In some example embodiments, the compact model may generate, as the simulation result data, a drain current corresponding to voltages such as a gate voltage and a drain voltage. In these cases, the simulation current-voltage curve may be generated based on drain currents output from the compact model where the drain currents are obtained by changing the voltages that are input to the compact model. As described above with reference to FIG. 10, the device data may indicate, e.g., structure and operation condition of the semiconductor device and the process data may indicate, e.g., condition of manufacturing process of the semiconductor device.

(125) A plurality of simulation reference points on the simulation current-voltage curve may be extracted (S201). The number and positions on the curve of the plurality of simulation reference points may be determined based on the characteristics of the semiconductor device.

(126) Basic training data corresponding to a combination of the plurality of simulation reference points and the simulation current-voltage curve may be generated (S301).

(127) A deep learning model may be trained based on the basic training data such that the deep learning model outputs a prediction current-voltage curve and uncertainty data indicating uncertainty of the prediction current-voltage curve (S401). The simulation current-voltage curve and the prediction current-voltage curve may indicate electrical characteristics of the semiconductor device.

(128) A target prediction current-voltage curve of the semiconductor device included in the target semiconductor product may be generated based on the deep learning model and a plurality of target reference points corresponding to the target semiconductor product (S501). The target semiconductor product may be a new semiconductor product, e.g., which is not included in the plurality of semiconductor products corresponding to the plurality of compact models.

(129) The deep learning model may be retrained based on the uncertainty data (S601).

(130) In some example embodiments, as will be described below with reference to FIG. 14, a first retraining may be performed such that the deep learning model that has been trained based on the basic training data is further trained based on the model uncertainty value.

(131) In some example embodiments, as will be described below with reference to FIG. 16, a

second retraining may be performed such that the deep learning model that has been trained based on the basic training data is initialized, and the initialized deep learning model is trained based on the data uncertainty value.

(132) As such, the method and the computing device according to some example embodiments may provide the deep learning model configured to precisely predict the characteristics of the semiconductor device by training the deep learning model to output the prediction current-voltage curve indicating the characteristics of the semiconductor device and the uncertainty data indicating the uncertainty of the prediction current-voltage curve and retraining the deep learning model based on the uncertainty data. Through the enhanced prediction performance of the deep learning model, the time and/or the cost of designing and/or manufacturing the semiconductor product including the semiconductor device and the performance of the semiconductor product may be enhanced.

(133) FIG. 12 is a diagram for describing types of uncertainty in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(134) In FIG. 12, the horizontal axis indicates input data of a deep learning model, and the vertical axis indicates prediction data (e.g., current values of a prediction current-voltage curve output from the deep learning model). FIG. 12 illustrates an example distribution of the prediction data provided using the deep learning model. The input data may be divided into first through fifth ranges RG1~RG5 according to the distribution of the prediction data.

(135) For example, the prediction data indicating the characteristics of the semiconductor device may increase linearly according to the input data. In these cases, the prediction data from an ideal deep learning model may coincide with a dotted line of a uniform slope in FIG. 12.

(136) The prediction data have a relatively large distribution in the first range RG1 and have a relatively small distribution in the fifth range RG5.

(137) The large distribution of the prediction data may be caused by noises in the input data and/or the training data. The uncertainty of the prediction data caused by noises in the training data may be referred to as data uncertainty (and/or aleatoric uncertainty).

(138) In contrast, the uncertainty of the prediction data caused by insufficiency of the training data in the second and fourth ranges RG2 and RG4 may be referred to as model uncertainty (and/or epistemic uncertainty).

(139) In some example embodiments, the uncertainty data output from the deep learning model may include a model uncertainty value indicating the uncertainty of the prediction data caused, e.g., by insufficiency of the basic training data. In these cases, as will be described below with reference to FIG. 14, a first retraining may be performed such that the deep learning model that has been trained based on the basic training data is further trained based on the model uncertainty value.

(140) In some example embodiments, the uncertainty data output from the deep learning model may include a data uncertainty value indicating the uncertainty of the prediction data caused by noises of the basic training data. In these cases, as will be described below with reference to FIG. 16, a second retraining may be performed such that the deep learning model that has been trained based on the basic training data is initialized, and the initialized deep learning model is trained based on the data uncertainty value. For example, weight values (e.g., defining a starting point in the deep learning model) may be set to small random values during a weight initialization process, thereby increasing the probability that the results of the deep learning model will converge.

(141) The deep learning model may be configured to output a model uncertainty value and a data uncertainty value through quantification of the model uncertainty and the data uncertainty.

(142) In some example embodiments, as described above, the deep learning model may include Bayesian Neural Network (BNN). The deep learning model may quantize the uncertainty using the Monte-Carlo Dropout scheme, the Deep Ensemble scheme, a quantile regression scheme, a Gaussian Process Inference scheme, combination thereof, and/or the like.

(143) As such, the method and computing device according to some example embodiments may efficiently provide the deep learning model capable of precisely predicting the characteristics of the

semiconductor device by determining the method of retraining the deep learning model based on the type of the uncertainty of the prediction data, e.g., the prediction current-voltage curve.

(144) FIG. **13** is a diagram illustrating an example embodiment of a deep learning model in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments. For convenience of illustration, the detailed configuration of a deep learning model is omitted and only the input layer IL receiving input data X and the output layer OL providing output data Y are illustrated in FIG. **13**.

(145) Referring to FIG. **13**, deep learning model DLM2 may be generated using a plurality of compact models CM1~CM8 respectively corresponding to a plurality of process data PR1-PR8.

(146) The basic training data TRD may be generated using the plurality of compact models CM1~CM8 such that the basic training data TRD correspond to a combination of a plurality of simulation reference points PNT and a simulation current-voltage curve IVC. A plurality of basic training data TRD corresponding to different combinations may be generated based on different values of the process data PR and the device data DV.

(147) In the example of FIG. **13**, the input data X of the deep learning model DLM1 may include the plurality of simulation reference points PNT. The output data Y may include the prediction current-voltage curve PIVC indicating the characteristics of the semiconductor device and the uncertainty data UC indicating the uncertainty of the prediction data PD. The supervised learning of the deep learning model MLM1 may be performed using the simulation current-voltage curve IVC as the ground-truth data of the prediction current-voltage curve PIVC with respect to input of the plurality of the simulation reference points PNT.

(148) FIG. **14** is a flow chart illustrating an example of retraining based on model uncertainty value in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments, and FIG. **15** is a diagram illustrating an addition data range in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(149) FIG. **14** illustrates a first retraining such that the deep learning model that has been trained based on the basic training data is further trained based on the model uncertainty value.

(150) Referring to FIGS. **2** and **14**, the training control module **240** operated by at least on processor of the processors **110** may compare the model uncertainty value with a model reference value (S311). As described above, the model uncertainty value may indicate the uncertainty of the prediction data caused by insufficiency of the basic training data. The model reference value may be determined as a proper value depending on target performance of the trained deep learning model.

(151) When the model uncertainty value is larger than the model reference value, addition training data different from the basic training data may be generated using the compact model (S312). The training control module **240** may retrain the deep learning model based on the addition training data (S313). The training control module **240** may, for example, not initialize the deep learning model that has been trained based on the basic training data and retain the deep learning model additionally based on the addition training data.

(152) FIG. **15** illustrates an example distribution of the model uncertainty value provided from the trained deep learning model. In FIG. **15**, the horizontal axes indicate the length L and the width W of a transistor, and the vertical axis indicates the model uncertainty value U_m .

(153) The training control module **240** may determine an addition data range RGm corresponding to a range of data such that the model uncertainty value U_m is larger than the model reference value. The training control module **240** may generate the addition training data such that the addition training data may correspond to a combination of the plurality of simulation reference points and the simulation current-voltage curve included in the addition data range and the corresponding simulation result data.

(154) FIG. **16** is a flow chart illustrating an example of retraining based on data uncertainty value in a method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example

embodiments, and FIG. 17 is a diagram illustrating a measurement data range in method of predicting characteristics of semiconductor device according to some example embodiments.

(155) FIG. 16 illustrates a second retraining such that the deep learning model that has been trained based on the basic training data is initialized, and the initialized deep learning model is trained based on the data uncertainty value.

(156) Referring to FIGS. 2 and 16, the training control module 240 operated by at least on processor of the processors 110 may compare the data uncertainty value with a data reference value (S321). As described above, the data uncertainty value may indicate the uncertainty of the prediction data caused by noises in and/or insufficiencies of the basic training data. The data reference value may be determined as a proper value depending on target performance of the trained deep learning model.

(157) When the data uncertainty value is larger than the data reference value, measurement data may be provided by measuring characteristics of the semiconductor device (S322), as described with reference to FIG. 3. The measurement data may be provided to the training control module 240.

(158) The training control module 240 may correct the compact model based on the measurement data (S324) and generate updated training data using the corrected compact model (S324). The training control module 240 may retrain the deep learning model based on the updated training data (S325). The training control module 240 may initialize the deep learning model that has been trained based on the basic training data, and then retain the initialized deep learning model based on the measurement training data. For example, weight values defining a starting point in the deep learning model may be set to small random values during a weight initialization process, thereby increasing the probability that the results of the deep learning model will converge.

(159) FIG. 17 illustrates an example distribution of the data uncertainty value provided from the trained deep learning model. In FIG. 17, the horizontal axes indicate the length L and the width W of a semiconductor device (e.g., a transistor) and the vertical axis indicates the data uncertainty value U_d .

(160) The training control module 240 may determine one or more measurement data ranges RGd1 and RGd2 corresponding to a range of data such that the data uncertainty value U_d is larger than the data reference value. The measurement data ranges RGd1 and RGd2 may be provided to the semiconductor manufacturing equipment 31 and the semiconductor measuring equipment 32 in FIG. 3, and the semiconductor manufacturing equipment 31 and the semiconductor measuring equipment 32 may provide the measurement data MD by measuring the characteristics of the semiconductor device corresponding to the device data included in the measurement data ranges RGd1 and RGd2.

(161) As described above, the method and the computing device according to some example embodiments may efficiently predict the characteristics of the semiconductor device included in a new semiconductor product, by generating the basic training data corresponding to the combinations of the simulation reference points and the simulation current-voltage curve using the established compact models corresponding to the previous semiconductor products and training the deep learning model based on the basic training data. In addition, the method and the computing device according to example embodiments may provide the deep learning model configured to precisely predict the characteristics of the semiconductor device by training the deep learning model to output the prediction current-voltage curve indicating the characteristics of the semiconductor device and the uncertainty data indicating the uncertainty of the prediction current-voltage curve, and retrain the deep learning model based on the uncertainty data. Through the enhanced prediction performance of the deep learning model, the time and/or the cost of designing and/or manufacturing the semiconductor product including the semiconductor device and the performance of the semiconductor product may be enhanced.

(162) As will be appreciated by one skilled in the art, the example embodiments in this disclosure

may be embodied as a system, method, computer program product, and/or a computer program product embodied in one or more computer readable medium(s) having computer readable program code embodied thereon. The computer readable program code may be provided to a processor and/or processors of a general purpose computer, special purpose computer, and/or other programmable data processing apparatus. The computer readable medium may be a computer readable signal medium and/or a computer readable storage medium. The computer readable storage medium may be any tangible medium that can contain, and/or store a program for use by or in connection with an instruction execution system, apparatus, or device.

(163) In this disclosure, the functional blocks and/or the terms “driver,” “unit,” and/or “module” may denote elements that process (and/or perform) at least one function or operation and may be included in and/or implemented as and/or in processing circuitry such hardware, software, or the combination of hardware and software. For example, the processing circuitry more specifically may include (and/or be included in), but is not limited to, a processor (and/or processors), Central Processing Unit (CPU), a controller, an arithmetic logic unit (ALU), a digital signal processor, a microcomputer, a field programmable gate array (FPGA), a System-on-Chip (SoC), a programmable logic unit, a microprocessor, application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC), etc. For example, the term “module” may refer to a software component and/or a hardware component such as a field programmable gate array (FPGA) or an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), and/or combination of a hardware component and a software component. However, a “module” is not limited to software or hardware. A “module” may be configured to be included in an addressable storage medium and/or to reproduce one or more processors. Accordingly, for example, a “module” may include components such as software components, object-oriented software components, class components, and task components, processes, functions, attributes, procedures, subroutines, segments of program code, drivers, firmware, microcode, circuits, data, databases, data structures, tables, arrays, and variables. A function provided in components and “modules” may be integrated with a smaller number of components and “modules” or divided into additional components and “modules”.

(164) The example embodiments may be applied to designing and manufacturing any electronic devices and systems. For example, the inventive concepts may be applied to (and/or in) systems such as a memory card, a solid state drive (SSD), an embedded multimedia card (eMMC), a universal flash storage (UFS), a mobile phone, a smart phone, a personal digital assistant (PDA), a portable multimedia player (PMP), a digital camera, a camcorder, a personal computer (PC), a server computer, a workstation, a laptop computer, a digital TV, a set-top box, a portable game console, a navigation system, a wearable device, an internet of things (IoT) device, an internet of everything (IoE) device, an e-book, a virtual reality (VR) device, an augmented reality (AR) device, a server system, an automotive driving system, etc.

(165) The foregoing is illustrative of some example embodiments and is not to be construed as limiting thereof. Although a few example embodiments have been described, those skilled in the art will readily appreciate that many modifications are possible in the example embodiments without materially departing from the present inventive concepts.

Claims

1. A method of predicting characteristics of a target semiconductor device included in a target semiconductor product, the method being performed by at least one processor executing program codes, the program codes stored in computer readable media, the method comprising: generating a simulation current-voltage curve using a plurality of compact models, the plurality of compact models respectively corresponding to a plurality of process data and a plurality of semiconductor products, and each of the plurality of compact models is configured to perform a simulation based on device data such that simulation result data, indicating characteristics of semiconductor devices

corresponding to the device data, is generated; extracting a plurality of simulation reference points on the simulation current-voltage curve; generating basic training data corresponding to a combination of the plurality of simulation reference points and the simulation current-voltage curve; training a deep learning model based on the basic training data such that the deep learning model is configured to output a prediction current-voltage curve; and generating a target prediction current-voltage curve based on the deep learning model and a plurality of target reference points corresponding to the target semiconductor product, wherein the deep learning model is a generative adversarial network.

2. The method of claim 1, wherein the deep learning model is further configured to output a discrimination value based on the simulation current-voltage curve and the target prediction current-voltage curve such that the discrimination value indicates a similarity between the simulation current-voltage curve and the prediction current-voltage curve.

3. The method of claim 2, wherein the discrimination value approaches 0 as the prediction current-voltage curve further deviates from the simulation current-voltage curve, and the discrimination value approaches 1 as the prediction current-voltage curve further approaches to the simulation current-voltage curve.

4. The method of claim 3, wherein the deep learning model is trained such that the discrimination value approaches 0.5.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein the target semiconductor device is a transistor, and the simulation current-voltage curve indicates a change of a drain current of the transistor based on a change of a gate voltage of the transistor with respect to a drain voltage of the transistor.

6. The method of claim 5, wherein a number of the plurality of target reference points is equal to a number of the plurality of simulation reference points, and a combination of the drain voltage and the gate voltage corresponding to each of the plurality of target reference points is equal to a combination of the drain voltage and the gate voltage corresponding to each of the plurality of simulation reference points.

7. The method of claim 1, wherein the target semiconductor product is a new semiconductor product that is not included in the plurality of semiconductor products corresponding to the plurality of compact models.

8. The method of claim 1, wherein the plurality of process data is based on a process-group combination of a process type, the process type indicating a manufacturing process of each of the plurality of semiconductor products and a product group in which each of the plurality of semiconductor products is included, and the target semiconductor product corresponds to a new process-group combination that is not included in the process-group combinations of the plurality of semiconductor products.

9. The method of claim 1, further comprising: retraining the deep learning model based on uncertainty data, wherein the uncertainty data indicates uncertainty of the target prediction current-voltage curve, and the deep learning model is configured to further output the uncertainty data.

10. The method of claim 9, wherein the uncertainty data include a model uncertainty value indicating the uncertainty of the prediction current-voltage curve caused by insufficiency of the basic training data.

11. The method of claim 10, wherein retraining the deep learning model includes: comparing the model uncertainty value with a model reference value; generating addition training data using the plurality of compact models when the model uncertainty value is larger than the model reference value; and retraining the deep learning model based on the addition training data, wherein the addition training data is different from the basic training data.

12. The method of claim 11, wherein retraining the deep learning model further includes: determining an addition data range corresponding to a range of the device data such that the model uncertainty value is larger than the model reference value, and wherein the addition training data correspond to a combination of the plurality of simulation reference points and the simulation

current-voltage curve.

13. The method of claim 11, wherein the deep learning model is further trained based on the addition training data.

14. The method of claim 9, wherein the uncertainty data include a data uncertainty value indicating the uncertainty of the prediction current-voltage curve caused by noises in the basic training data.

15. The method of claim 14, wherein retraining the deep learning model includes: comparing the data uncertainty value with a data reference value; producing measurement data by measuring the characteristics of the target semiconductor device when the data uncertainty value is larger than the data reference value; correcting at least one of the plurality of compact models based on the measurement data; generating updated training data using the corrected at least one compact model; and retraining the deep learning model based on the updated training data.

16. The method of claim 15, wherein retraining the deep learning model further includes: determining a measurement data range corresponding to a range of data such that the data uncertainty value is larger than the data reference value, and wherein the measurement data are provided by measuring characteristics of the target semiconductor device corresponding to the device data included in the measurement data range.

17. The method of claim 15, wherein the deep learning model that has been trained based on the basic training data is initialized, and the initialized deep learning model is trained based on the updated training data.

18. A method of predicting characteristics of a semiconductor device included in a target semiconductor product, the method being performed by at least one processor executing program codes, the program codes stored in computer readable media, the method comprising: generating a simulation current-voltage curve of the semiconductor device using a plurality of compact models, the plurality of compact models respectively corresponding to a plurality of process data and a plurality of semiconductor products, each of the plurality of compact models configured to perform a simulation based on device data such that simulation result data, indicating characteristics of semiconductor devices corresponding to the device data, is generated; extracting a plurality of simulation reference points on the simulation current-voltage curve; generating basic training data corresponding to a combination of the plurality of simulation reference points and the simulation current-voltage curve; training a deep learning model based on the basic training data such that the deep learning model is configured to output a prediction current-voltage curve and uncertainty data indicating uncertainty of the prediction current-voltage curve; generating a target prediction current-voltage curve based on the deep learning model and a plurality of target reference points corresponding to the target semiconductor product; and retraining the deep learning model based on the uncertainty data, wherein the deep learning model is a generative adversarial network.

19. A computing device comprising: a computer readable medium storing program codes and a plurality of compact models, the plurality of compact models respectively corresponding to a plurality of process data and a plurality of semiconductor products, each of the plurality of compact models configured to perform a simulation based on device data such that simulation result data, indicating characteristics of semiconductor devices corresponding to the device data, is generated; and at least one processor configured to, when executing the program codes, generate a simulation current-voltage curve of a semiconductor device using the plurality of compact models, extract a plurality of simulation reference points on the simulation current-voltage curve, generate basic training data corresponding to a combination of the plurality of simulation reference points and the simulation current-voltage curve, train a deep learning model based on the basic training data such that the deep learning model is configured to output a prediction current-voltage curve, and generate a target prediction current-voltage curve based on the deep learning model and a plurality of target reference points corresponding to a target semiconductor product, wherein the deep learning model is a generative adversarial network.

20. The computing device of claim 19, wherein the deep learning model is further configured to

output a discrimination value based on the simulation current-voltage curve and the prediction current-voltage curve such that the discrimination value indicates similarity between the simulation current-voltage curve and the target prediction current-voltage curve.
